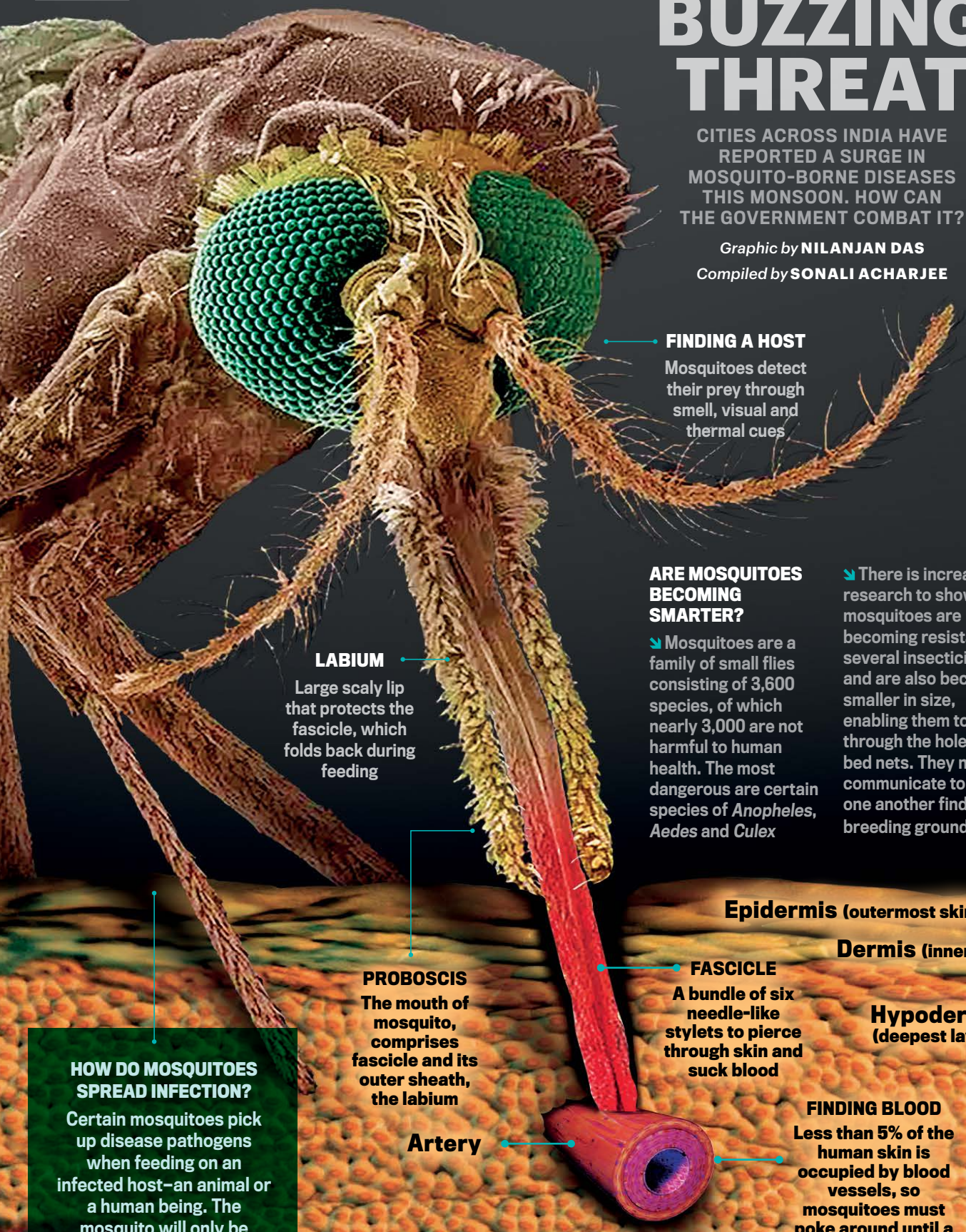
BUZZING THREAT

CITIES ACROSS INDIA HAVE REPORTED A SURGE IN MOSQUITO-BORNE DISEASES THIS MONSOON. HOW CAN THE GOVERNMENT COMBAT IT?

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**

Compiled by **SONALI ACHARJEE**



FINDING A HOST

Mosquitoes detect their prey through smell, visual and thermal cues

LABIUM

Large scaly lip that protects the fascicle, which folds back during feeding

PROBOSCIS

The mouth of mosquito, comprises fascicle and its outer sheath, the labium

FASCICLE

A bundle of six needle-like stylets to pierce through skin and suck blood

Artery

FINDING BLOOD

Less than 5% of the human skin is occupied by blood vessels, so mosquitoes must poke around until a suitable blood vessel is found

Epidermis (outermost skin layer)

Dermis (inner layer)

Hypodermis (deepest layer)

ARE MOSQUITOES BECOMING SMARTER?

Mosquitoes are a family of small flies consisting of 3,600 species, of which nearly 3,000 are not harmful to human health. The most dangerous are certain species of *Anopheles*, *Aedes* and *Culex*

There is increasing research to show that mosquitoes are becoming resistant to several insecticides, and are also becoming smaller in size, enabling them to enter through the holes of bed nets. They now communicate to help one another find safer breeding grounds

HOW DO MOSQUITOES SPREAD INFECTION?

Certain mosquitoes pick up disease pathogens when feeding on an infected host–an animal or a human being. The mosquito will only be infected if the pathogen survives its immune system. When this infected mosquito bites a human, it transmits the pathogen by releasing saliva